



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Harrisonville Classical Christian Academy

School Website: <https://harrisonvillecca.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Harrisonville Classical Christian Academy (HCCA) demonstrates clear classical and Christian orientation, anchored by a biblical worldview, Memoria Press curriculum, and engagement with the Western classical tradition (great books, Latin, liberal arts). Public materials emphasize formation of character, wisdom, and virtue, and they position parents as partners in a classical education journey. The school also signals a robust community and parental involvement, with explicit references to a Statement of Faith and a mission to train students in leadership and service within a Christian framework. However, explicit, in-depth articulations of core classical pedagogy (e.g., sustained Socratic seminars in upper grades, Scholé-style restfulness, and a fully explicit articulation of the Trivium/Quadrivium in public-facing materials) are less visible in the readily accessible site content, suggesting mixed strength across the full six-element rubric.

Overall, the school falls into **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. It exhibits strongest alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Parents & Community, and strong alignment in Curriculum, with more modest but present alignment in School Purpose and Goal and Pedagogy, and some growth potential in clearly detailing all six classical pedagogical modes (especially explicit Socratic/seminar methods and a fully explicit Trivium/Quadrivium articulation). The aggregate assessment reflects a balance of classical strengths with areas where explicit public articulation could be sharpened.

Key evidentiary signals include: the biblical Christian framing and Statement of Faith; the Memoria Press-based classical curriculum and emphasis on Great Books and Latin; the mission to form character and wisdom; and explicit calls for parental partnership and involvement. Citations drawn from the school site content include statements about a historic biblical worldview, non-denominational Christian identity, and the classical curriculum rooted in Memoria Press (and great books) along with references to a parental partnership ethos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- The school presents itself as a Christian, non-denominational institution with a Classical Christian Education philosophy and a biblical worldview. This is explicit in statements about partnering with parents to educate students in a historic biblical worldview and its Christian orientation.
- The Vision page foregrounds a biblical framework and theology, including references to thinking on truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian context.
- The site includes a Statement of Faith in its navigation, reinforcing theological grounding.

- Curriculum references include Memoria Press within a Judeo-Christian context and a Western civilizational heritage, signaling theological underpinnings in coursework. Positive keyword indicators (from the Six Essentials lexicon): biblical worldview, theology, Creator, truth/goodness/beauty, liturgical/worship-oriented language, Christian faith, sacred tradition.
- In public-facing materials, positive signals strongly emphasize transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a theologically grounded framework, while explicit liturgical practices beyond school-wide Faith statements are less visible in the accessible content. Negative indicators (e.g., secular relativism) are not evident in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: biblical worldview; Creator; true/good/beautiful (transcendentals); Statement of Faith; theology; Christian worldview; liturgical/communal hints through the contextual language of reverence and sacred tradition in the materials. Estimated presence: high (4+ distinct, explicit indicators).
- Negative keywords observed: none detected in public-facing content.

Why this rating

- The school's public materials clearly anchor education in a Christian worldview and theological framing, with explicit references to biblical truth and a Statement of Faith. This strongly aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria, even if some liturgical rituals are not exhaustively documented in the public materials. The balance tips toward CLASSICAL in this category given the explicit theological grounding and transcendentals emphasis.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission emphasizes character formation and wisdom, with a view toward serving God through leadership, service, and character. This reflects formation over mere information and aligns with the classical telos of the person rather than job preparation.
- The Vision and mission articulate a formation-centric aim: to develop knowledge, understanding, and wisdom, and to shape students in a way consistent with a classical, Christian worldview.
- The curriculum and philosophy speak to the Great Books/Western tradition and a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ends. The Great Books framing and the classical heritage convey a formation-oriented telos that transcends mere information transfer.
- The school's public materials reference a historic biblical worldview and a commitment to virtue, character, and wisdom as core aims.

Positive keyword indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, human flourishing, moral imagination.

- Positive keyword instances in public content: formation/virtuous aims; wisdom; telos; truth/goodness/beauty framing; liberal arts/human formation language.

Negative keyword indicators: none overtly present (no strong signals of workforce-preparation bias or purely utilitarian framing in the public materials).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent telos, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for School Purpose and Goal. The explicit formation emphasis and the aim toward human excellence through virtuous inquiry and contemplation align with the classical framework.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school uses Memoria Press Core Curriculum, a widely recognized classical curriculum, with emphasis on classical literature and Latin, signaling explicit engagement with classical content and methods.
- Public materials indicate a focus on great books and Western tradition as part of the curriculum, including statements about the classical heritage of the Christian West and the Western canon.
- References to Great Books and “the Great Conversation” in public materials underscore an emphasis on primary texts and enduring questions.
- Latin instruction is explicitly noted as part of the curriculum, which aligns with the classical emphasis on language study as part of a liberal arts education.

Positive keyword indicators: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Latin; Western civilization; primary sources; classical literature; liberal arts; historical depth.

- Positive keyword instances in public content: Memoria Press Core Curriculum; classical literature and Latin; great books; Western tradition; liberal arts language.

Negative keyword indicators: Some categories from the classical lexicon emphasize the Trivium/Quadrivium and direct table-of-contents language for a tightly integrated liberal-arts foundation; the public content does not always explicitly enumerate grammar/logic/rhetoric in public-facing pages, though it is implied through Memoria Press and classical content.

Why this rating

- The presence of Memoria Press, explicit Great Books orientation, and Latin indicates strong classical curriculum underpinnings, which supports CLASSICAL in this category. However, explicit mentions of the full Trivium/Quadrivium structure and a fully detailed, public-facing articulation of all liberal-arts elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric) are less overt in the visible materials, which justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than a full CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials indicate that the curriculum uses a classical framework that includes memory-based and recitation elements (Memoria Press focus on classical pedagogy often includes memorization, chant, and canonical texts). The preschool/kindergarten language explicitly notes “think and memorize using the Memoria Press classical curriculum,” signaling memory-based pedagogy as part of lower grades.
- The school emphasizes thinking critically and engaging with texts in a classical mode, but explicit, widespread mention of Socratic seminars or scholé across upper grades is not clearly documented in the accessible site content. The public-facing materials emphasize classical approach and formation rather than a detailed pedagogy mapping.
- The material highlights a combination of traditional (memory, reading, recitation) and inquiry-oriented aspects (Great Books, texts, critical thinking), but explicit, scalable articulation of Socratic pedagogy across grades is not consistently visible in the public pages.

Positive keyword indicators: Socratic dialogue (explicit in classical pedagogy lexicon), Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, living curriculum, didactic/monastic cadence, rhetoric/declamation.

- Positive keyword instances in public content: explicit memory-focused approach (through Memoria Press), a stated aim to form students by engaging with classic texts; public mention of thinking critically.

Negative keyword indicators: The site does not clearly document broad adoption of fully Socratic seminars across all grades or a strict project-based, constructivist approach, which would be a negative signal in this category.

Why this rating

- The public materials show a classical orientation and a pedagogy that includes memory work and classical texts but lack explicit, detailed evidence of a full, consistently documented Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across all grade levels. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site features a “Meet the Educators” section and lists the Head of School, indicating active faculty leadership, and suggests a professional, engaged faculty as a core element (the living curriculum).
- The Vision and Mission emphasize mentorship, character, and leadership, implying teachers as moral exemplars and guides.
- While there is evidence of faculty roles and a leadership structure, there is less public documentation of a formal “portrait of a teacher” or a defined living-curriculum faculty culture beyond general statements. The explicit portrait language and a clearly articulated “faculty as living curriculum” phrasing are not consistently visible in the public pages.

Positive keyword indicators: master teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture.

- Positive keyword instances in public content: presence of named educators and leadership; references to mentorship and character formation.

Negative keyword indicators: absence of a strongly articulated, formal “portrait of what a teacher should be” or systematized classical-faculty profile language in the public pages.

Why this rating

- There is clear evidence of active, qualified faculty leadership and a mission that elevates teacher role, but the public articulation of a deeply codified “faculty as living curriculum” or a robust, clearly defined classical-faculty profile is less explicit. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnering with parents to educate students in a historic biblical worldview, explicitly describing parents as co-teachers and as partners in formation. This is a core element reflected in the mission and orientation.
- The site features multiple parent-facing items (Parent Volunteers, Cottage Academy, parent-facing handbooks) and a family-oriented admission/participation model (e.g., Cottage Academy with collaboration with parents).
- The public materials indicate that the school welcomes parental involvement, open campus style, and a culture of family engagement, including book studies and gatherings as described in the Six Elements lexicon (and evidenced by the site’s parent-focused pages and navigation).

Positive keyword indicators: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, open campus, parent education, classical parent training.

- Positive keyword instances in public content: explicit statements about partnering with parents and parent involvement; references to family-centered activities and governance.

Negative keyword indicators: no substantive negative signals about parental involvement in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly emphasize parental partnership and parental involvement as central to classical education, which aligns solidly with the Parents & Community category's positive indicators. This category is CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Make explicit, public-facing statements of the full Trivium and Quadrivium structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) and demonstrate how Great Books, primary sources, and liberal arts are woven throughout all grades. Include explicit references to Great Books and primary texts in grade-band playlists and sample syllabi. This would strengthen the categorical alignment to CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly articulate a differentiated, scalable pedagogy that includes explicit Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars in upper grades, along with Scholé/restful learning moments embedded throughout the day. Provide concrete examples from syllabi or a published pedagogy guide to demonstrate how memory work, recitation, and modeling excellence are integrated with inquiry.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Develop and publish a formal "Portrait of a Classical Teacher" and a "Living Curriculum" faculty model, including ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy and a visible, codified teacher-professional-formation framework. This would help elevate Element 5 to CLASSICAL.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): While formation is clearly emphasized, additional explicit language that frames formation as the primary telos of education (over job/work-readiness) in public-facing materials would fortify CLASSICAL alignment. Consider a concise, public articulation of telos and the philosophical rationale behind formation as the aim of education.
- Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Consider more explicit articulation of liturgical or communal practices in public-facing materials (e.g., morning prayers, liturgical calendar integration, or communal worship language) to strengthen the Liturgical/Communal Practices signal while maintaining the existing theological framing.
- Family and Community: Maintain and deepen explicit parent-education offerings (book studies, lectures) and ensure visits by parents are encouraged as a standard practice. This would further reinforce the CLASSICAL signal in Parents & Community.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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